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OFFICIAL TRAVEL DOSSIER

Escora

PREPARED EXCLUSIVELY FOR MR. & MRS. ARVIND MENON

The Grand Kerala Sojourn — 9 Nights of Backwaters, Hills & Heritage

A meticulously paced nine-night journey through Kerala's most storied landscapes — from the colonial lanes of Fort Kochi to the mist-veiled tea estates of Munnar, the still backwaters of Alleppey, the wildlife-rich hills of Thekkady, and the sun-warmed shores of Kovalam. Every stay has been hand-selected for character, every transfer timed for comfort, and every day left with room to breathe.

DESTINATION	TRAVEL DATES	DURATION
Kerala, India	10 December 2026 – 19 December 2026	10 Days

Journey Unfolds

DAY 1 • 10 DECEMBER 2026

DAY 2 · 11 DECEMBER 2026

Kochi Heritage Deep Dive & Drive to Munnar

A final unhurried morning in Kochi's art district before the scenic ascent into the Western Ghats.

08:30 **Breakfast at the property** — South Indian breakfast spread with filter coffee

09:30 **Santa Cruz Basilica & Kochi Biennale galleries** — Contemporary art spaces in restored colonial warehouses

11:00 **Depart for Munnar** — 4-hour scenic drive via Neriamangalam, with stops at Cheeyappara & Valara waterfalls

15:30 **Check-in at tea estate bungalow** — Afternoon tea served on the veranda overlooking the plantation

17:00 **Sunset at Top Station viewpoint** — Panoramic views into Tamil Nadu's Western Ghats

DAY 3 · 12 DECEMBER 2026

Munnar — Tea Estates & Eravikulam National Park

A full day immersed in the emerald geometry of Munnar's tea country, with a chance to spot the rare Nilgiri Tahr.

07:00 **Sunrise trek to Meesapulimala foothills** — Guided 2-hour trek with packed breakfast at the summit

10:30 **Tata Tea Museum** — History of Munnar's plantations and a tea-tasting session

13:00 **Lunch at a working tea estate** — Planter's-table lunch amid the tea bushes

15:00 **Eravikulam National Park** — Shuttle bus into the park; home to the endangered Nilgiri Tahr and Anamudi, South India's highest peak

19:00 **Bonfire dinner under the stars** — Private bonfire arranged on the estate lawn

DAY 4 • 13 DECEMBER 2026

Munnar to Thekkady — Spice Trails & Periyar

Descend through spice-scented hills to Thekkady, gateway to the Periyar Tiger Reserve.

09:00 **Depart Munnar** — 3-hour drive through cardamom and pepper plantations

11:30 **Spice plantation walking tour** — Guided walk through cardamom, clove, nutmeg and vanilla plantations with tasting

14:00 **Check-in at rainforest lodge** — Lunch on arrival

16:30 **Periyar Lake boat safari** — Wildlife spotting cruise on Periyar Lake — elephants, bison and birdlife along the shoreline

20:00 **Kalaripayattu martial arts show** — Kerala's ancient martial art form performed live

DAY 5 · 14 DECEMBER 2026

Thekkady — Wildlife & Ayurveda

A day balancing adventure in the reserve with restorative Ayurvedic treatment.

06:00 **Border hiking trail** — Guided 3-hour nature walk through Periyar's buffer forest with an armed tribal guide

10:00 **Breakfast at the lodge**

11:30 **Traditional Ayurvedic massage** — 90-minute Abhyanga massage with certified therapists

15:00 **Elephant care experience** — Ethical, no-riding interaction — feeding and bathing rescued elephants

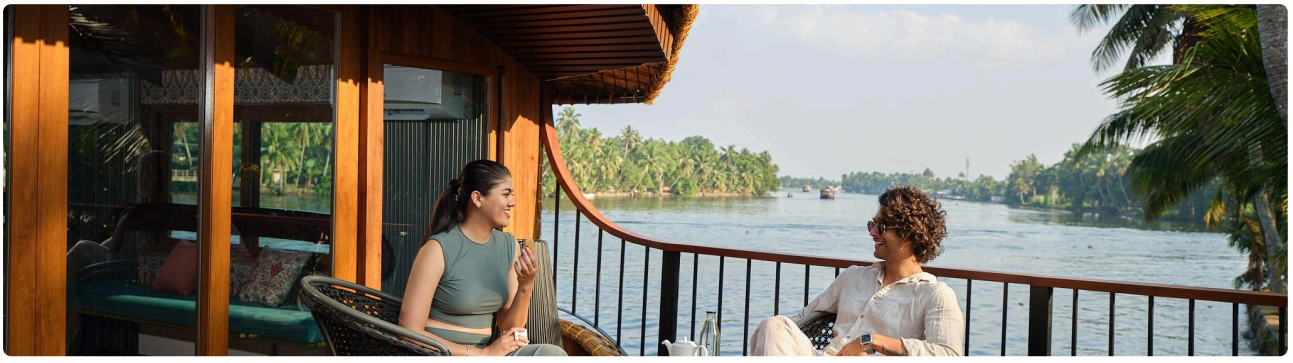
19:30 **Spice-infused dinner** — Chef's tasting menu featuring local spices

DAY 6 · 15 DECEMBER 2026

Thekkady to Alleppey — Backwater Arrival

Journey to the backwaters and board your private houseboat for an overnight cruise through Kerala's canal country.

- **08:30** **Depart Thekkady** — 3.5-hour drive to Alleppey through Kumily and the Kuttanad rice belt
- **12:30** **Board private houseboat** — Traditional kettuvallam with 2 AC bedrooms, sundeck and private chef
- **13:00** **Welcome lunch cruising the backwaters** — Fresh Kerala fish curry, prepared onboard
- **16:00** **Village canal detour** — Narrow canoe transfer through a coir-weaving village
- **19:00** **Sunset dinner on the sundeck** — Anchored on Vembanad Lake for the night



DAY 7 · 16 DECEMBER 2026

Alleppey Backwaters to Kovalam Coast

A gentle morning cruise before the drive south to Kerala's palm-fringed coastline.

- **07:00** **Sunrise on the sundeck** — Coffee served as the houseboat begins its return cruise
- **09:00** **Disembark & breakfast**
- **10:30** **Depart for Kovalam** — 4.5-hour scenic coastal drive via Kollam
- **16:00** **Check-in at clifftop beach resort** — Sea-facing room with private balcony
- **18:00** **Lighthouse Beach sunset** — Stroll along Kovalam's iconic crescent beach

DAY 8 · 17 DECEMBER 2026

Kovalam — Leisure & Watersports

A free day by the Arabian Sea, with optional watersports and a sunset cruise.

- **09:00** **Leisure morning at the resort** — Full use of pool, spa and private beach access
- **11:00** **Optional watersports** — Jet-ski, banana boat and parasailing available at the beach club
- **14:00** **Seafood lunch on the sands** — Beachside shack lunch — catch of the day grilled to order
- **17:30** **Sunset catamaran cruise** — Private 2-hour sail along the Kovalam coastline with chilled refreshments

DAY 9 · 18 DECEMBER 2026

Kovalam — Trivandrum Heritage Excursion

A half-day exploring the temples and museums of the state capital before a final evening by the sea.

- **09:00** **Depart for Trivandrum** — 45-minute drive
- **10:00** **Napier Museum & Zoo** — Indo-Saracenic architecture and Kerala's natural history collection
- **12:30** **Kanyakumari-style thali lunch** — Traditional Travancore-region vegetarian feast
- **15:00** **Return to Kovalam** — Afternoon at leisure
- **19:00** **Farewell dinner** — Private candlelit dinner on the beach, arranged by your Escora concierge

DAY 10 · 19 DECEMBER 2026

Departure

A relaxed final morning before transfer to Trivandrum International Airport for your onward journey.

09:00 **Late check-out & breakfast** — Leisurely final breakfast overlooking the sea

11:00 **Airport transfer** — Private vehicle to Trivandrum International Airport (approx. 45 minutes)

Where You'll Rest

FORT KOCHI · 1N

Brunton Boatyard

Harbour View Room

10 December 2026 — 11 December 2026

Colonial-era boatyard converted into a heritage hotel overlooking the harbour mouth

MUNNAR · 2N

Windermere Estate

Planter's Bungalow Suite

11 December 2026 — 13 December 2026

Working tea and cardamom estate at 5,000 ft, run by the same family for three generations

THEKKADY · 2N

Cardamom County

Rainforest Cottage

13 December 2026 — 15 December 2026

Rainforest-edge property bordering the Periyar Tiger Reserve buffer zone

ALLEPPEY BACKWATERS · 1N

Private Kettuvallam Houseboat

2-Bedroom AC Deluxe Houseboat

15 December 2026 — 16 December 2026

Traditional rice barge with private chef, sundeck and en-suite bedrooms

KOVALAM · 3N

Taj Green Cove

Sea-View Cottage

16 December 2026 — 19 December 2026

Clifftop resort set in 22 acres of tropical gardens above Lighthouse Beach

Inclusions & Exclusions

INCLUDED

- ✓ 9 nights' accommodation across 5 handpicked heritage, estate, houseboat and beach properties
- ✓ Daily breakfast at all properties, plus welcome and farewell dinners
- ✓ All ground transportation in a private air-conditioned vehicle with English-speaking chauffeur
- ✓ Private kettuvallam houseboat charter with dedicated chef and crew
- ✓ All entrance fees and permits for Eravikulam National Park and Periyar Tiger Reserve
- ✓ Guided Fort Kochi heritage walk and spice plantation tour
- ✓ Periyar Lake wildlife boat safari
- ✓ One 90-minute traditional Ayurvedic massage per couple
- ✓ Ethical elephant care experience in Thekkady
- ✓ Kathakali dance and Kalaripayattu martial arts performances
- ✓ Sunset catamaran cruise in Kovalam
- ✓ 24/7 dedicated Escora concierge support throughout the journey
- ✓ All applicable taxes and service charges

EXCLUDED

- ✗ International and domestic flights
- ✗ Visa fees and travel insurance
- ✗ Lunches not specified in the day-by-day itinerary
- ✗ Alcoholic beverages and personal expenses
- ✗ Optional watersports in Kovalam (jet-ski, parasailing, banana boat)
- ✗ Camera/video fees at monuments where applicable
- ✗ Tips and gratuities for drivers, guides and houseboat crew
- ✗ Any airport departure taxes not included in airfare

Investment & Payment

INVESTMENT COMPONENT	AMOUNT (INR)
Accommodation — 9 nights across 5 properties	₹2,85,000
Private houseboat charter with chef & crew	₹38,000
Ground transportation & private chauffeur	₹62,000
Guided experiences & park entrance fees	₹34,000
Ayurveda, wellness & cultural performances	₹22,000
Meals as per itinerary (breakfasts, welcome & farewell dinners)	₹41,000
Escora concierge service & trip planning	₹18,000
Discount	-₹15,000
Taxes & Fees	₹24,750
TOTAL INVESTMENT	**₹5,09,750**

Price is per couple, based on double occupancy. Valid for travel between November 2026 and February 2027. A 25% deposit confirms this itinerary; balance due 30 days before arrival.